

Father Edward

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It ought to be selfunderstood that no simple reading of any book is going to move the Heart of Heaven in our favor. Only inasmuch as any book or page can serve to raise the heart to God and thus draw His blessings to us can it be said to have any quality of prayer about it. But besides this, to profit by reading, even the holyist prayers - even about God Himself - the heart of the reader must be disposed. In other words if we want to profit by our reading about God and His saints we must read with reverence. We must appreciate. We speak of the Holy Bible, the Holy Gospel, etc, because the Church has declared them to be inspired writings and because millions have profited from their perusal; have learned to believe in God and to love Him by devoutly reading about him therein. Others have read therein without profit; others again to their own detriment. Why so? How? Failure of disposition; Want of reverence. "unlearned and unstable" wresting the scripture to their own destruction.

Now in my opinion, there is hardly another book written outside the Bible itself, more "inspired-like and more inspiring than this wonderful work, "the Mystical City of God" Its introduction alone, if read with prayerful attention will hardly leave a doubt as to its supernatural origin. The opposition it has met with from the beginning, positively on part of Hell and irreligion is another proof of its worth in the saving of immortal souls. Its emphatic and reiterated approval on the part of Catholic universities, Bishops and Popes in face of said opposition, as well as, its manifest harmony with Holy Scripture, philosophy & sacred theology - in fact its outstanding preeminence in relation to each and all of these - and its acknowledged crowning and climax in asceticism, ought to remove every honest doubt as to the sincerity and candor as well as the humility of the actual writer, that it is not her own but the work of the peerless Mistress of heavenly Wisdom - under divine guidance nothing less than the autobiography of the incomparable Queen of the Universe, Mary conceived without - Virgin Mother of God.

(Unfinished Draft)